



Q.11) Patronage from rulers of the time coupled with spread and popularity of Buddhism made a huge contribution towards the art, architecture and sculpture of ancient India. Discuss. (15 Marks, 250 Words)

बौद्ध धर्म के प्रसार और लोकप्रियता के साथ समकालीन शासकों के संरक्षण ने प्राचीन भारत की कला, वास्तुकला और मूर्तिकला को बहुत बड़ा योगदान दिया। चर्चा करें। (15 अंक, 250 शब्द)

Buddhism has enriched the art and architecture landscape of India through literature, paintings, caves and sculptures.

The reason for this contribution is largely due to the patronage of rulers, which also led to the wider adoption of Buddhism.

Patronage

- 1. Mauryan Empire
- 1. Buddhist Councils

These were patronised by Ajatasatru (483 BC), Kalasoka (283 BC), Ashoka (250 BC) and Kanishka (72 AD) which contributed to Buddhist literature

eg. Vinayapitakas, Jatakas, etc.

2. Ashoka

The patronage & spread of Buddhism led to creation of Architectural marvels — Stupas, Viharas and Chaityas

eg. Sanchi Stupa.

3. Kushanas (Kanishka)

The patronage provided created schools of sculpturing like Gandhara and Mathura school which created Buddhist sculpture

eg. Sarnath Seated Buddha
Bamiyan Standing Buddha.

4. Guptan period

This period led to the development of paintings in Ajanta caves that are still the richest source of Buddhist art.

Further, Gupta sculptures are also found. eg. Sabri Sahibgunj bronze Buddha

5. Satvahanas

They patronised the Amaravati school
of sculpture & Architecture.

eg. Amaravati Stupa, Seated & Standing
Buddha Sculptures.

6. Pala Dynasty

- They ~~created~~ ^{maintained} the magnificent
Nalanda University as well
as the Mahabodhi temple, Gaya.

Such patronage also led to
the spread of Buddhism to other
countries, thus we find Buddhist
art & architecture across South &
South East Asia eg. Srilanka, Afghanistan, etc.

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Structure		Content	
Question Interpretation		Total :	